

# Network plugins comparison

| Property                                    | Kubenet (retired in 2028)                              | Azure CNI                                  | Azure CNI overlay                            |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>VNET IPs required</b>                    | Few                                                    | Many                                       | Few                                          |
| <b>Pod-to-pod communication</b>             | Uses UDR                                               | Direct – using subnet IPs                  | Direct – using overlay network               |
| <b>Good fit if</b>                          | Most of the traffic is within the cluster              | Most of the traffic is outside the cluster | Most of the traffic is within the cluster    |
| <b>Multiple clusters in the same subnet</b> | Not supported                                          | Supported                                  | Supported                                    |
| <b>Nodes limit</b>                          | 400                                                    | 1000 / 5000                                | 1000 / 5000                                  |
| <b>Doesn't support</b>                      | Windows nodes<br>Azure Network Policy<br>Virtual Nodes | -                                          | Windows Server 2019<br>Virtual Nodes<br>AGIC |